

■ Colour My Webpage!

A Grade 1 HTML Coding Lesson

Subject:	Computer Science / Coding
-----------------	---------------------------

Grade Level:	Grade 1 (Ages 6–7)
---------------------	--------------------

Duration:	45–60 Minutes
------------------	---------------

Topic:	Adding Colours to HTML Webpages
---------------	---------------------------------

Every webpage is a blank canvas — paint it with colour! In this lesson, young coders discover how to use HTML to bring their webpages to life with vibrant colours, fun backgrounds, and creative combinations.

■ Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- ◆ Explain what HTML is and why it is used to build webpages.
- ◆ Use the style attribute to change the colour of text in HTML.
- ◆ Apply the background-color property to change a webpage's background.
- ◆ Identify at least four colour names (red, blue, green, purple) used in HTML.
- ◆ Explain what a hex code is and provide one example (#FF0000 = red).
- ◆ Distinguish between colour names and hex codes.

■ Materials Needed

For Students	For the Teacher
• Computer or tablet with a browser • Simple text editor (Notepad / TextEdit) • Printed colour reference card • Crayons / coloured pencils (optional)	• Projector or interactive whiteboard • This lesson plan printout • Sample HTML files (starter + completed) • Colour chart poster

■ Background Knowledge

What is HTML?

HTML (HyperText Markup Language) is the language used to build webpages. Think of it like a recipe — it has special instructions called **tags** that tell the computer what to show on the screen. HTML makes the internet come alive!

Adding Colours to HTML

Colours make webpages fun and pretty. With HTML, we can paint our webpages with any colour we like — brightening up text, headings, and backgrounds.

■ Key Concepts

The style Attribute

We use the **style** attribute inside an HTML tag to add colour. The property **color** changes text colour; **background-color** changes the background.

Colour Names

Simple English words like **red**, **blue**, **green**, and **purple** work directly in HTML. They are easy to remember and great for beginners!

Hex Codes

Hex codes are secret colour codes that start with # and have 6 letters or numbers (e.g. **#FF0000** = red, **#FF69B4** = pink, **#87CEEB** = sky blue). They unlock thousands of colours beyond simple names.

Colour Names vs Hex Codes

Both methods work in HTML. Colour names are easy to remember; hex codes give far more choices. Beginners start with names, then graduate to hex codes.

■ Lesson Plan (Step-by-Step)

Step 1: Warm-Up: What Colours Do You See?

5 min

Ask students to look around the classroom and name their favourite colours. Then ask: *"Did you know we can use those same colours to decorate a website?"* Show a plain white webpage on the projector. Invite a student to suggest a colour for the background — set the stage for the lesson!

Step 2: Introduction to HTML

10 min

Explain that HTML is like a recipe that tells the computer what to show. Just as a recipe has steps, HTML has **tags**. Display a simple HTML page on the board and point to the opening and closing tags. Keep the explanation fun — compare tags to sandwich bread that wraps around the filling!

Step 3: The style Attribute — Colouring Text

10 min

Introduce the **style** attribute. Write the following example on the board and type it live so students can see the result:

```
<p style="color: red;">Hello World!</p>
```

Explain that **color** tells the computer what to change, and **red** is the colour we want. Then change *red* to *blue*, then *green* — let students call out the next colour to try!

■ Try changing 'red' to other colours like blue, green, or purple!

Step 4: Colour Names You Can Use

5 min

Introduce the four starter colour names with fun associations:

◆ ■ red — bright and bold!

◆ ■ blue — cool like the sky and ocean!

◆ ■ green — fresh like leaves and grass!

◆ ■ purple — royal and magical!

Step 5: Hex Codes — Secret Colour Codes!

8 min

Explain that hex codes are special colour codes starting with # followed by 6 letters or numbers. Show examples:

```
#FF0000 → Red #FF69B4 → Hot Pink #87CEEB → Sky Blue #FFDAB9 → Peach
```

Discuss the difference: colour names are easy to remember; hex codes open up thousands more colours. Ask students which they prefer and why.

Step 6: Changing the Background Colour

7 min

Show students how to colour the entire webpage background using the **background-color** property:

```
<body style="background-color: #FFDAB9;">
```

Demonstrate changing the background from peach to other colours — both with colour names and hex codes. Encourage students to suggest their favourite colour!

■ *Try changing the background to your favourite colour!*

Step 7: Hands-On Practice

10 min

Students now try it themselves! Provide a simple starter HTML file. Guide them through these three challenges:

◆ Challenge 1 — Pick a colour name and change the heading text colour.

◆ Challenge 2 — Use a hex code to colour a paragraph.

◆ Challenge 3 — Change the page background to your favourite colour!

Step 8: Share & Wrap-Up

5 min

Ask 2–3 volunteers to show their colourful webpages to the class. Celebrate each creation! Recap the key tips before closing:

◆ Use `style="color: colourname;"` to colour text.

◆ Use `style="background-color: hexcode;"` for backgrounds.

◆ Colour names are easy; hex codes give more choices.

◆ Have fun experimenting — every page is a blank canvas!

■ Colour Reference Card

Distribute or display this card during practice time.

Colour Name	HTML Name	Hex Code	Swatch
Red	red	#FF0000	
Blue	blue	#0000FF	
Green	green	#008000	
Purple	purple	#800080	
Hot Pink	hotpink	#FF69B4	
Sky Blue	skyblue	#87CEEB	
Peach	peachpuff	#FFDAB9	
Orange	orange	#FFA500	
Yellow	yellow	#FFFF00	
Black	black	#000000	

■ Assessment & Extension

Formative Assessment (during lesson)

- ◆ Observe whether students can type a colour name correctly into the style attribute.
- ◆ Ask: 'What does background-color do?' — check for understanding.
- ◆ During practice, check that both text and background colour changes work.

Exit Ticket Questions

- ◆ What does HTML stand for? (HyperText Markup Language)
- ◆ Write the code to make text green.
- ◆ What symbol does a hex code start with? (#)
- ◆ Name one difference between colour names and hex codes.

Extension Activity

Early finishers can try the **Mix and Match Challenge**: colour the heading one colour and the body text another, then choose a complementary background — all using hex codes. Encourage them to try pastel shades for a soft, gentle look.

■ Remember These Tips!

◆ Use `style="color: colourname;"` → changes text colour

◆ Use `style="background-color: hexcode;"` → changes background

◆ Colour names: red, blue, green, purple (easy to remember!)

◆ Hex codes start with # and have 6 characters: #FF0000

◆ Have fun experimenting — there are millions of colours to try!